

Parks Board Meeting December 16, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jg9luatSGtQ
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Park and Recreation Board

Date: December 16, 2025

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Park and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, December 16, 2025, initiating proceedings with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** James Leton, Mark Urban, Shannon Powers, Grant Marshall
 - **Absent:** Chandra Park (excused due to family commitment)
 - **Presiding Officer:** James Leton (identified through meeting moderation)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board stood for the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the November meeting were approved without discussion or revisions by voice vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:12:50 Fulley Park Mural Site Agreement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courtney Marsh, President of the Southside Neighborhood Association.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Courtney Marsh presented a site agreement for a community-funded mural project on the concession building at Fulley Park, utilizing American Rescue Plan funds. The project is being coordinated alongside the Muncie Arts and Community Culture program and "Storyboard" (with representative Marissa). Over 200 initial art renderings were narrowed down via community surveys and events to three finalists, with artist Brian Villinger receiving the highest community approval. The project includes a graffiti-protectant coating to facilitate easy cleanup of potential vandalism. The Southside Neighborhood Association requested board approval of the site agreement prior to formalizing contracts with the artist. Target installation is slated for March to April 2026, weather permitting.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (presented by neighborhood association leadership).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (pending legal review).

00:24:05 Prairie Creek Reservoir Operations & Lease Extension

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Misty, Assistant Superintendent of City Parks and Prairie Creek Reservoir; Carl Malone, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Misty provided operational updates regarding the reservoir, noting ongoing challenges with low staffing, winterization, and the ongoing recruitment for an operations manager (over 80 applicants screened). Staff have been working to remove remaining docks (15 wooden piers and 12 floating piers remaining) as weather permits.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Charlene Moore, President of Friends of Prairie Creek, spoke during the public input / discussion window regarding the recent sudden announcement to close the campground. She voiced deep disappointment from campers and elderly residents over the short notice, difficulties and double-costs associated with moving campers in winter weather, security concerns for stored items, and the lack of prior board consultation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Following extensive discussion regarding the hardship of the December 31st camper removal deadline during winter conditions, board member Grant Marshall moved to extend the winter storage lease move-out date. The board **Approved by Voice Vote** a formal lease extension through end-of-day **May 3rd, 2026**, at no additional fee. Individual lease extensions will require signed documentation coordinated through the legal team.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:00:46 Christopher:** Addressed the board regarding transparency and governance. He noted the absence of the mayor and city engineer from the meeting, expressed strong frustration over decisions being made behind closed doors without public or board inclusion, and criticized the administration's handling of the Prairie Creek Reservoir campground closure. He commended the board for pushing back and voting to extend the camper move-out deadline.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Superintendent Carl Malone and board members thanked Assistant Superintendent Misty for her service, noting that she will be exploring other opportunities and will be missed by the department.
 - Board members exchanged holiday greetings (Merry Christmas / Happy Holidays).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second.
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